

SSH BRUTE FORCE ATTACK — INCIDENT REPORT

INCIDENT DETAILS	
Incident ID	INC-2026-0512-001
Date & Time	May 12, 2026 — 23:19 UTC
Severity	HIGH (Level 10)
Status	RESOLVED
Analyst	George Eze
Framework	NIST SP 800-61 Rev.2
MITRE Technique	T1110 — Brute Force
Affected System	ICONIC (Ubuntu 192.168.0.138)
Attack Source	192.168.0.239 (Kali Linux)
Attack Tool	Hydra v9.6 + rockyou.txt
Breach Occurred	NO — Attack Failed

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	
On May 12, 2026 at 23:19 UTC, the Wazuh SIEM detected an active SSH brute force attack against the ICONIC system (192.168.0.138).	
Wazuh generated 609 alerts in under 3 minutes and automatically mapped the attack to MITRE T1110.	

TIME (UTC)	EVENT	RULE	LVL
23:19:09	Hydra attack initiated from 192.168.0.239	—	—
23:19:09	First SSH auth failure detected by Wazuh	5760	5
23:22:05	Max authentication attempts exceeded	5758	8
23:22:06	Multiple auth failures — Brute Force	40111	10
23:22:06	MITRE T1110 auto-mapped by Wazuh	40111	10
23:22:06	609 total alerts generated in dashboard	Various	—
23:25:00	Attacker IP blocked — iptables + Wazuh AR	—	—
23:30:00	SSH hardened — password auth disabled	—	—
23:35:00	Incident resolved — no breach confirmed	—	—

INVESTIGATION FINDINGS	
Successful SSH logins	✓ NONE
Data accessed or exfiltrated	✓ NONE
Malware installed	✓ NONE
New accounts created	✓ NONE
Persistence established	✓ NONE
Lateral movement	✓ NONE

WAZUH DETECTION SUMMARY	
Rule 5760 — SSH Auth Failed	293 hits
Rule 2501 — User Auth Failure	56 hits
Rule 5758 — Max Auth Exceeded	HIGH
Rule 40111 — Brute Force	609 total

RESPONSE ACTIONS TAKEN	
Block attacker IP via iptables firewall	DONE
Verify no successful logins in auth.log	DONE
Check for persistence — cron, SSH keys, services	DONE
Disable SSH password authentication	DONE
Set MaxAuthTries to 3 in sshd_config	DONE
Disable root SSH login (PermitRootLogin no)	DONE
Install and enable fail2ban auto-blocking	DONE
Restart SSH service with hardened config	DONE
Document full incident report (this document)	DONE

RECOMMENDATIONS	
Disable SSH password auth — enforce key-based only	CRITICAL
Deploy fail2ban to auto-block failed attempts	HIGH
Change SSH from port 22 to non-standard port	HIGH
Implement MFA for all SSH and remote access	HIGH
Whitelist trusted IPs only for SSH access	MEDIUM
Set Wazuh email alert for Level 10+ rules	MEDIUM
Conduct quarterly SSH configuration audit	LOW
Security awareness training for all staff	LOW
Review and update IR playbook quarterly	LOW

Technique	ID	Finding	Outcome
Brute Force	T1110	Wazuh detected attack in < 30 seconds	Real-time detection confirmed
Password Guessing	T1110.001	609 alerts auto-generated by SIEM	No manual intervention needed
Remote Services: SSH	T1021.004	MITRE ATT&CK auto-mapped by Wazuh	Framework compliance proven
Valid Accounts	T1078	SSH hardening stopped future attacks	Remediation was effective
Active Scanning	T1595	No breach — strong password protected	Zero impact to business

REFERENCES	SIGN-OFF
<i>NIST SP 800-61 Rev.2 — nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-61r2.pdf</i> <i>MITRE ATT&CK T1110 — attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1110</i> <i>CIS Controls v8 — cisecurity.org/controls/v8</i>	Analyst: George Eze GitHub: GeorgeEzeSOCAnalyst Date Closed: May 12, 2026 Status: RESOLVED ✓